Minimal Risk Registration Form

Section A: Confirm that your study requires KCL ethical clearance

Before completing a Minimal Risk Registration Form, you may find it useful to read through the accompanying guidance. Further advice for each question has been provided in information icons. Please ensure you have read these icons to confirm the eligibility of the project.

1 Is your study considered research as defined in the guidance icon information?
Please note studies deemed to be either a service evaluation or audit do not require ethical clearance.

- (•) Yes
- ( ) No

2 Does your study require external ethical review by either the Health Research Authority (which includes the NHS REC and Social Care REC) or the Ministry of Defence REC?
Please note - any research with NHS patients or NHS data will always require HRA review. Research with NHS staff-only may require HRA review. If you require HRA or NHS REC review, please select 'YES'. See guidance icon for further information on the HRA and MOD REC ethical review remit.

- ( ) Yes
- (•) No

3 Please indicate which of the following data collection methods your study involves:
Please note: You should only select the methods that you are certain will be employed for the project and you are able to outline in section 20(d).

- [x] Interviews
- [ ] Focus Groups/Workshop
- [ ] Questionnaires/Surveys/App based research tool
- [ ] Non-interventional classroom observations
- [ ] All other non-interventional observations
- [ ] Physical procedures (e.g taking body temperature, wearing a virtual reality headset, taking pulse)

Please note: Analysis of pre-existing data is not eligible for the Minimal Risk Registration Process. Before continuing, if your study involves the analysis of pre-existing data, please visit our 'Analysis of pre-existing data' page for advice on whether or not you will need to complete a 'Full Application Form' for ethical approval

Section B: Confirm that your study does not require High Risk review

IMPORTANT: Please note, the minimal risk self-registration process does not involve an ethics review conducted by the Research Ethics Office or the College Research Ethics Committee. As such it is the responsibility of the researcher and their supervisor (if applicable) to assess the potential risks involved to determine a projects eligibility. This should be done by carefully considering if each of the below questions may apply to the project.

Further information on of these potential risks can be found within the guidance icon of each question. If you select an answer that means the project is not eligible for minimal risk registration, you will be instructed complete a new full application form.

Minimal risk self-registration forms are subject to random audit. If a project is found to be ineligible during the audit process, ethical clearance for the project would not be valid and would be treated as research conducted without the correct level ethical clearance.

Before continuing, please confirm the following:

- [x] I understand the minimal risk self-registration process is not subject to review by the Research Ethics Office or the College Research Ethics Committee and I am responsible for assessing the potential risks in line with the guidance provided.

6 Does your study present any of the following risks to participants? (see information icon for guidance)

- [ ] a) Vulnerability: Does the study involve participants who are vulnerable, unable to give informed consent, or in a dependent position?
- [ ] b) Consent and deception: Will participants be asked to take part in the study without their informed consent or knowledge at the time, or will deception or an incomplete disclosure of any sort be involved?
- [ ] c) Participant disclosures: Could participants disclose details of their involvement in illegal activities or other activities that represent a threat to themselves or others or could lead to personal or professional reprisals (e.g. drug use, or professional misconduct)?
- [ ] d) Stress and anxiety: Could the study induce psychological stress or anxiety, or produce humiliation or cause harm or negative consequences beyond the risks encountered in a participant's usual, everyday life?
- [ ] e) Urgent mental health risks: Could participation in this research identify urgent mental health risks, including, but not limited to, suicidal ideation and/or self-harm intent?

You should only select the statement below if you have not selected any of the above risks. Your application will be invalid if you select the below statement in addition to any of the above.

- [x] I have answered no to all questions in the risk checklist above and I do not believe that my research is high risk

Section C: Confirm that your study does not require Low Risk review

7 Will any participants be under the age of 16?

- ( ) Yes
- (•) No

8 Will participation involve any subjects of the following nature?

Please note: The following points still apply if participation is anonymous. See information icon for further guidance.

- ☐ Subjects of a personal nature where it cannot be assumed that participants will feel at ease engaging with these topics without prior consideration
- ☐ Subjects that may not directly relate to lived experiences but do involve sensitive or controversial topics that you cannot assume a participant will be comfortable discussing
- ☐ Identification of low-level negative states. For example, the use of the Hospital Anxiety and Depression Scale (HADS)
- ☐ Details of personal medical history including past or current diagnoses or treatments
- ☑ None of the above

9 Do you have a current or prior relationship with any potential participants? (This includes professional and/ or personal relationships)

- ◉ Yes, I do have a current or prior relationships with potential participants.
- ○ No, I do not have any current or prior relationships with potential participants.

9a If you are in a position of influence or authority over potential participants, is there a possibility this could give rise to a perceived pressure to participate?

Please note: If you are directly involved in the teaching of participants this is considered a perceived pressure to participate.

- ○ Yes, there is potential for my existing relationship to give rise to a perceived pressure to participate.
- ◉ No, there is no potential for my existing relationship to give rise to a perceived pressure to participate.

10 Gatekeeper Permission: Will you require an individual or organisation to grant you permission to approach/ access your intended participants? This includes gatekeepers contacting participants on your behalf.

Please note: if you will be attempting to access any closed online groups which require admin permission (such as private Facebook groups), this is considered to be use of a gatekeeper.

- ○ Yes, I will be using a gatekeeper to access potential participants
- ◉ No, I will not be using a gatekeeper to access potential participants

11 Can you confirm that the participants will not be subjected to any undue incentives to participate? (Receipt of a project report or a reasonable reimbursement such as travel/lunch costs or a voucher would not be considered undue incentives.)

- ○ Yes, participants will be subject to undue incentives
- ◉ No, participants will not be subjected to any undue incentives

12 You have determined that your project is eligible for minimal risk registration. Before completing your minimal risk registration form you must confirm that you have read the Minimal Risk Guiding Principles at the link below and that you will adhere to these principles in the conduct of your research.

Minimal Ethical Risk Guiding Principles

- ☑ I confirm that I have read the Minimal Risk Guiding Principles and will adhere to the principles within.

Section D: General Information

13 Applicant Details

Title	First Name	Surname
Mr	Mert	Ayranci

Department: Department of Informatics

Email: mert.ayranci@kcl.ac.uk

14 Faculty/Institute/School

Please refer to the information icon if you are unsure of your Faculty/Institute/School.

Natural and Mathematical Sciences

15 Applicant Status

Undergraduate

15 Supervisor Details

a)

Title	First Name	Surname
Dr	Kovila	Coopamootoo

Department: Department of Informatics

Email: kovila.coopamootoo@kcl.ac.uk

16 Are there any other investigators/collaborators involved in the study?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

Section F: Study Overview

18 Project Title

A working title for your project that accurately reflects its aims

Designing For Consent Revocation in online messaging platforms (WhatsApp Photo Sharing)

19 Anticipated start date for the collection of data: 20/03/2026

20 Study Overview: Briefly describe your research project, as you would to a potential participant, highlighting the aims of your research, who your participants are (type of people rather than individual names), how you will recruit them and what will be asked of them (try to use no more than 50 words for each section).

a) What are the aims of your study?

You should explain what the principal research question is and the specific objectives of the study

The principal research question of this study is: How can WhatsApp be designed to support clear, usable, and trustworthy mechanisms for revoking or modifying consent after users share photos in private conversations? The study focuses on the problem that, once a photo is sent, users often lose meaningful control over it, even though consent and comfort can change over time. The specific objectives are to examine the limitations of WhatsApp's current photo-sharing design, investigate users' expectations and concerns about post-sharing control, define requirements for effective consent-revocation features, design and prototype possible interface solutions, and then evaluate whether those proposed features are understandable, usable, trustworthy, and fair.

b) Who are your potential research participants?

This should outline any specific criteria participants must meet in order to be eligible take part (e.g. age, ethnicity, gender, members of a specific group etc.)

Potential participants for this study are adults aged 18–24 who are active users of mobile messaging platforms, particularly apps used for sharing photos in private conversations, such as WhatsApp. Participants should have regular experience of sending or receiving photos through these platforms so that they can meaningfully comment on the prototype and the scenarios shown during the interview.

c) How will participants be identified and approached?

This must address each data collection method selected in Q3. For example, if approaching potential participants in person you should explain the circumstances in which this will take place or if approaching potential participants by email you should explain how you will obtain email addresses.

Potential participants will be identified through purposive sampling. The study will recruit adults aged 18–24 who are active users of mobile messaging platforms and have experience sharing photos in private chats. Participants will be approached through the researcher's personal and university networks, for example by sending a short invitation message by email or direct message, or by sharing a recruitment message in relevant student or social groups.

d) What will participation involve?

Briefly explain how each data collection method, indicated in Q3, will be used to collect data. This should include what participants will be asked to do at each stage of the project.

Please note: Failure to address each method indicated in Q3 will result in your form being invalidated.

Participants will take part in a one-to-one semi-structured online interview. Before the interview starts, the researcher will explain the study verbally, answer any questions, and obtain verbal informed consent. With permission, the interview will be audio-recorded. Participants will first answer a few warm-up questions about messaging and photo-sharing practices, and will then be shown screenshots from a prototype. They will be asked to discuss what they think the screens mean, how they interpret the features, and how they feel about them. Follow-up questions will explore clarity, fairness, trust, and perceived control. At the end, participants will be asked a few final reflection questions. They may skip any question or stop participation at any time.

e) Provide example questions participants may be asked:

Provide an example of the types of questions participants may be asked for each data collection method selected in Q3. These examples should demonstrate the nature of the topics that will be discussed but does not need to be an exhaustive list.

Participants will be asked questions about their current use of messaging apps and photo-sharing practices, as well as their reactions to a series of prototype screenshots. Example questions include: “Can you tell me how you usually share photos on apps like WhatsApp?”, “Have you ever wanted more control over a photo after sending it?”, “What do you think is happening on this screen?”, “What do you think these settings mean?”, “How would you feel if access to a shared photo changed after it was sent?”, “Does this feel fair to both sender and recipient?”, and “Would a feature like this make you feel more in control or trust the platform more?” These examples are illustrative and not exhaustive.

21 Confirm which of the following consent processes will be used:

- ☐ Written Consent: Written consent will be recorded in either paper or electronic form in advance of participation. A written description of the research will also be provided to all potential participants.
- ☑ Verbal Consent: I am able to demonstrate that written information and consent is not practical, or not appropriate, so I confirm that I will follow College guidance on providing information and gaining consent from participants verbally.
- ☐ Anonymous submission of survey/questionnaire/app based research tool data: A written description of the research will be provided to all potential participants and it will be made clear that the submission of a completed survey/questionnaire/app data implies consent.
- ☐ Non-invasive observations that do not involve any interaction with participants and no identifying information will be recorded.

21a Explain why written consent is not practical or appropriate.

Written consent is not considered practical for this study because participation takes place remotely through online interviews, and the project involves minimal risk. Instead, the study will be explained verbally at the start of each interview, participants will have the opportunity to ask questions, and verbal informed consent will be obtained before any data is collected

◉ Provisions for verbal consent: I confirm that I will follow KCL guidelines on gaining verbal consent and wherever practically possible I will provide all potential participants with appropriate written study information. This should include researcher contact details for purposes of questions, complaints or withdrawal requests.

Please note, where possible when obtaining verbal consent participants should be provided with a written information sheet. You should also ensure you have created a record of the consent process.

KCL guidelines on gaining verbal consent and template information sheets

22 Does the project involve the collection and/or use of personally identifiable information (as outlined in UK GDPR)?

Identifiable information is data that can be used to identify an individual, either directly (such as full name, address, Twitter handle, etc) or indirectly through the combination of several pieces of data. The most common examples are names, contact details, audio/ video recordings, usernames etc. However, data that has the potential to indirectly identify a participant should also be treated as identifiable.

Please see the guidance icon for more examples of when data should be considered identifiable or contact the Research Governance Office: rgo@kcl.ac.uk

Please indicate which of the following applies:

- ○ Yes, the project involves the collection and/or use of identifiable information
- ◉ No, all data I will collect or access for this research will be completely anonymous. It will not be possible for me to identify an individual(s) at any point in the project.

PLEASE NOTE:

- **If you are using email addresses to contact participants you should select 'Yes' under question 22 above.**
- **If you are asking participants to sign consent forms with their name and/or signature you should select 'Yes' under question 22 above**

◉ I understand that it is the responsibility of the researcher to ensure that all research data is appropriately handled and stored during and after the study in compliance with College guidelines:

King's research data management guidelines and King's Data Retention Schedule guidance

Section G: Declaration and Signatures

23 Researcher/Applicant Declaration:
IMPORTANT NOTE FOR STUDENTS: Please ensure that you have signed the form in this section before requesting your Supervisor's signature in section 24 below.

By signing this form I confirm the following:

- The information supplied above is to the best of my knowledge accurate.
- I understand the minimal risk self-registration form is not subject to review by CREC or the REO, and it is my responsibility to ensure the project meets the minimal risk eligibility criteria based on the guidance provided.
- I have read the Minimal Ethical Risk Guiding Principles and clearly understand my obligations and the rights of participants, particularly as regards obtaining informed consent.
- The participant selection and recruitment procedures, including the recruitment documents to be provided and the manner of obtaining informed consent, are appropriate and the ethical issues arising from the project have been considered (and agreed with my Supervisor if applicable).
- I understand that I must not commence research with human participants until I have received confirmation of minimal risk registration.

Signed: This form was signed by Mert Ayranci (mert.ayranci@kcl.ac.uk) on 20/03/2026 16:26

24 Supervisor Declaration:

Once you have electronically signed the form in section 23, you should then request your Supervisor's signature using the below 'Request' button. Once your Supervisor has also signed the form the form will be automatically submitted for registration.

Please note: Following submission for registration you must wait until you have received a letter from REMAS confirming that your project has been registered before commencing data collection.

Request Supervisor's Signature:	**Signed:** This form was signed by Kovila Coopamootoo (kovila.coopamootoo@kcl.ac.uk) on 23/03/2026 12:18